

On the tech transformation side, G20 outcomes of Global Digital Public Infrastructure Repository (GDPIR) and 'Global Initiative on Digital Health' do enjoy a broader consensus and we will strive to drive a full consensus during the negotiations.

As far as gender equality is concerned, the empowerment of women and girls has been a key priority for our presidency and has also been hailed very positively by all members of the G20. We have been able to push the issue of digital and economic empowerment of women and girls to the centre of G20 discussions. In fact, many G20 Sherpas were appreciative of the fact that India's proposed text on gender equality is the strongest they have seen in years.

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*How far has the needle moved on other issues such as global cryptocurrency regulations, which has been a key priority for India?*

Regulation of stable crypto assets is an outcome of the Finance Track, and the ministry is leading the negotiation on that front.

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*One of the topics enunciated as India's focus area has been the debt management situation for vulnerable and developing economies after the pandemic exacerbated their public debt levels. We have seen such crises unfold in countries like Sri Lanka. Do you expect some relief measures to be agreed upon by the G20 on this front?*

The G20 is working on putting together a note on the global debt landscape as part of the Finance Track outcomes. India has already set an example by helping Sri Lanka through its extended line of credit which helped them secure the IMF bailout and put them on track to restructure their debt. G20's Common Framework has also helped in paving the path for Zambia's debt restructuring. We are committed to make this framework more inclusive and effective at the G20.

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*The climate crisis is an urgent issue that needs global co-operation. The floods in north India have once again highlighted this issue. To what extent have the G20 talks focussed on this and what key takeaways are expected?*

India's G20 presidency constituted a specific working group to address disaster risk, the Disaster Risk Reduction (DRR) Working Group. Floods in north India are devastating news for all of us, and we hope our DRR working group's outcomes related to early warning systems, disaster response mechanisms



in coordination with Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure (CDRI) are discussed in the G20 meetings and key outcomes within this regard are delivered successfully.

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*India took over the G20 presidency from Indonesia. What has been the progress made in the last one year on issues that remained unresolved in Bali?*

Over the past year, we have been engaged in ensuring that the G20 is committed to the 1.5°C pathway while meeting the climate finance goal. Following the New Global Financing Pact Summit in Paris this year, along with our deliberations across the Sherpa and Finance tracks, we are pushing for commitments on development and climate finance, particularly around leveraging private capital. The sheer size of investments required in developing countries for climate and SDG goals means that public sources of funding will not be enough. We must also leverage private capital. Now, with the report of the Independent Expert Group (IEG) on reforming multilateral development banks (MDBs), we are taking steps at the G20 to reform the MDBs and improve climate and development finance for the developing world.

Building on our efforts of including MSMEs and people into the digital economy, we have been focussing our efforts towards making the digital economy inclusive for